USF IEEE COMPUTER SOCIETY · IEEE Florida West Coast Chapter

How Large-Scale Tech Projects Really Work

Data, Cutover & Hypercare in Fortune 100 Transformations

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A practical, hour-long look at how large enterprises move data, run cutover, and stabilize through hypercare — and how to break into this work.

SESSION ROADMAP

What We'll Cover in the Next Hour

01

Anatomy of a Transformation

How Fortune 100 programs are structured, end to end

02

Five Field-Tested Lessons

Data, cutover, hypercare, alignment, and AI — what separates programs that succeed

03

By the Numbers

What these programs really cost, and where they break

04

Tools & Roles

Concrete platforms to learn and real job titles to target

05

Growth Path & Hireable Skills

How careers progress, and what recruiters actually screen for

06

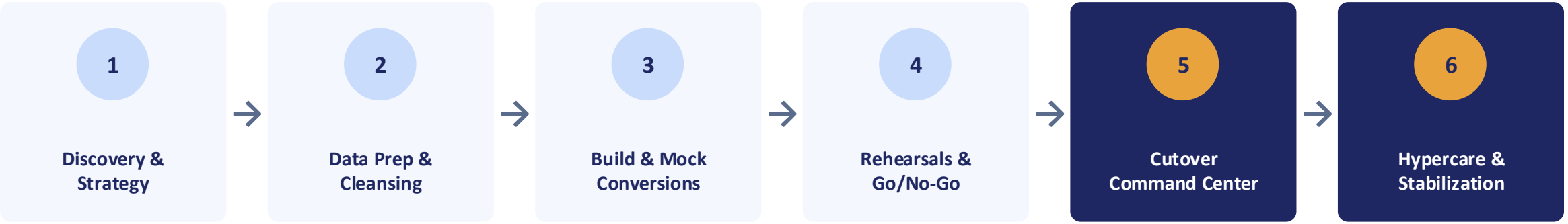
Your Action Plan

Concrete steps to start building toward this career this semester

SECTION 01

The Anatomy of a Large-Scale Transformation

Every Fortune 100 modernization program moves through the same core phases — regardless of industry.



Cutover is the fulcrum — hypercare is where the organization proves the change actually stuck. Everything before it is preparation; everything after is validation.

LESSON 01

Data Is the Foundation, Not an Afterthought

Legacy data quality determines whether go-live succeeds — long before the first line of code runs.

DB

1st

of major programs, data is the very first workstream to stand up

- Data cleansing, validation, and reconciliation start months before cutover — not the week before.
- AI-augmented anomaly detection now catches defects that mock conversions used to miss.
- Every downstream system inherits whatever data-quality decisions were made upstream.
- Treat data governance as its own workstream with a named owner — not a side task for IT.

LESSON 02

Cutover Is a Command-Center Discipline

Go-live weekend is where months of planning either pay off — or unravel in public.

GO

3–6

months of rehearsal and mock-conversion cycles before a typical go-live

- Mock conversions and rehearsal cycles surface load-sequencing issues while they're still cheap to fix.
- A command center gives one place for real-time monitoring, escalation, and decisions.
- Go/no-go criteria are agreed with executives before the weekend — never negotiated during it.
- Automated runbooks turn tribal knowledge into a repeatable, teachable process.

LESSON 03

Hypercare Is Where Adoption Is Won or Lost

Go-live is a technical milestone — hypercare is where the business decides if the change actually worked.



- Defects, workarounds, and user confusion surface fastest in the first few weeks after go-live.
- Command-center-style monitoring continues: dashboards track tickets, performance, and exceptions in real time.
- Change management doesn't end at go-live — training reinforcement decides if users adopt or revert.
- Define hypercare exit criteria in advance, just like go/no-go — or 'temporary' support becomes permanent.

LESSON 04

Stakeholder Alignment Beats Perfect Technology

The best architecture fails if executives, business owners, and delivery teams aren't reading from the same page.



Alignment Habits That Scale

- Define go/no-go criteria before you need them — not during a crisis.
- Give steering committees a consistent, honest weekly cadence.
- Translate technical risk into business impact executives can act on.

LESSON 05

AI & Automation Are Now Core to Delivery

The transformation toolkit has changed — agentic workflows now do work that used to take whole teams.

AI

Most

new delivery tooling now ships with an AI or automation component

- AI-driven anomaly detection accelerates defect resolution during mock conversions.
- Agentic workflows deliver reliable, production-grade datasets at a scale manual QA can't match.
- Intelligent RPA bots now handle repetitive reconciliation and validation tasks.
- The differentiator isn't knowing a tool exists — it's knowing where to trust automation, and where not to.

SECTION 03

By the Numbers: What Transformation Really Looks Like

70%

of transformations fail to meet original goals — execution is everything.

$50M+

average project cost for a mid-to-large enterprise transformation program.

300+

defects logged in a typical week during the first 30 days of hypercare.

12–36

months from kickoff to go-live for a full-scale enterprise transformation.

These numbers aren't meant to scare you — they're meant to show you where the opportunities are. Companies desperately need people who can navigate this complexity.

SECTION 04

Tools Worth Learning

You don't need to master all of these — hands-on fluency with a few signals real, job-ready experience.

1 Data & Migration

- SAP Datasphere / Business Data Cloud
- Syniti ADM (Advanced Data Migration)
- Informatica or Talend
- Collibra (data governance & catalog)

2 Cutover & Delivery

- Cutover (cutover.com platform)
- ServiceNow
- Smartsheet, Jira & Confluence
- SAP Activate methodology

3 Hypercare & Monitoring

- ServiceNow ITSM
- Splunk or Datadog
- Power BI or Tableau dashboards
- Incident / ticket triage tooling

4 AI & Automation

- SAP Joule (generative AI copilot)
- UiPath or Automation Anywhere
- Microsoft Power Automate
- Prompt-based data QA workflows

SECTION 05

Roles to Target

Real job titles to search for — many are open to new grads with the right internship or certification.

Entry-Point Roles

- Data Migration Analyst / Data Quality Analyst
- Business Analyst (ERP / Transformation)
- Associate or Analyst Consultant (Big 4 / SI firm)
- Cutover Coordinator / Cutover Analyst
- Hypercare Support Analyst
- RPA / Automation Developer

Where They Lead

- Cutover Manager / Cutover Lead
- Data Migration Lead
- Change Management Consultant
- Solution Architect
- Program Manager / PMO Lead
- Transformation Leader / Engagement Manager

A TYPICAL GROWTH PATH

Every Stage Adds a Layer of Scope

From executing tasks to owning enterprise-wide outcomes.

0–2 yrs

Analyst / Associate Consultant

Data cleansing, unit testing, writing specs

2–4 yrs

Technical or Functional Lead

Owns a workstream, sets standards and estimates

4–7 yrs

Migration or Cutover Specialist

Subject-matter depth in one high-value area

7–10 yrs

Delivery / Program Manager

Owns a multi-million-dollar workstream

10–15 yrs

Solution Architect

Designs the target-state solution end to end

15+ yrs

Transformation Leader

Owns full programs and executive relationships

SECTION 06

Skills That Actually Get You Hired

Recruiters at Fortune 100 firms screen for both columns — technical depth alone isn't enough.

T

Technical Skills

- Core platform depth (ERP/SAP, cloud, or your domain's system of record)
- Data profiling, cleansing, and migration fundamentals
- Working fluency with AI-augmented tooling and automation
- Certifications that validate skills to hiring managers fast
- Enough coding/scripting to understand what you're overseeing

P

Power Skills

- Translating technical risk into terms executives act on
- Staying calm and decisive when a go-live is on the line
- Writing and presenting so a steering committee trusts you
- Mentoring — the fastest way to be trusted with more scope
- Comfort owning a decision when the answer isn't clean

SECTION 07

Your Action Plan, Starting This Semester

1

Pick a Platform and Go Deep

Choose one enterprise platform (SAP, cloud, or similar) and get certified. Depth beats a scattered resume.

2

Build a Project You Can Talk About

A capstone, hackathon build, or lab project gives you a concrete story for interviews.

3

Get Hands-On, One Tool Per Category

Pick one data tool, one cutover/PM tool, and one AI/automation tool — and actually use them.

4

Find a Mentor and Stay Visible

IEEE, professional societies, and campus hackathons are exactly where mentors get found.

5

Search for the Exact Role Titles

Use the entry-point job titles from earlier — more specific than 'consultant,' easier to find.

6

Say Yes to the Unglamorous Scope

Data cleansing and documentation work is where trust — and bigger opportunities — get built.

Thank You

Questions, career advice, or feedback — happy to keep the conversation going.

John Sajja

